DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO PROJECT REPORT

Course Code: CSE0001

Course Title: Digital Literacy

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Introduction

This project was completed from the perspective of a Student Digital Ambassador whose role is to help fellow students use digital tools in a smarter, safer, and more professional way. The portfolio combines visual communication, online profile building, collaboration tools, professional email writing, and cybercrime awareness into one practical submission. Each task was designed to reflect a real digital skill that students need in college and beyond. Through this project, I understood that digital literacy is not limited to using devices or apps; it also includes judgement, online safety, communication, and digital identity. The work collected in this repository shows both technical awareness and responsible online behaviour, which are essential for academic growth and long-term professional development.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For the first task, I created a one-page infographic to explain the meaning and importance of digital literacy in a simple and visually structured format. The design covers key areas such as the definition of digital literacy, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. I used a presentation-style visual layout so that the content remains easy to read at a glance and useful for awareness sharing among batchmates. The infographic was designed to look clean, modern, and informative instead of overly decorative, because the main purpose was clarity.

Canva was the primary tool used to design the infographic with a clean layout, proper color contrast, and easy-to-understand visual elements.

What I found most interesting while making this task was how much information can be communicated effectively through design when the points are short and well-organised. The slightly difficult part was balancing visual quality with content coverage, because an infographic should not look crowded. This task helped me realise that digital awareness content becomes more effective when it is visually engaging and concise. It also showed me that digital literacy is a broad concept that combines skill, responsibility, communication, and safety rather than just technical knowledge.

Task 2 – Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I selected GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle as the three platforms for building a foundational student digital portfolio. GitHub is useful for hosting repositories, documenting projects, and showing technical progress over time. LinkedIn is important for maintaining a professional academic profile and connecting with recruiters, professors, alumni, and industry professionals. Kaggle is valuable for exploring datasets, notebooks, competitions, and beginner-level data science learning. Together, these platforms represent coding, networking, and skill-building in a practical way.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to maintain my academic and personal projects, LinkedIn to document achievements and professional growth, and Kaggle to explore technical learning beyond classroom assignments. This task made me understand that a digital profile is like an ongoing portfolio rather than a one-time setup. It should grow with projects, skills, certifications, and experiences. Keeping such platforms professional from the beginning can create strong opportunities later for internships, collaborations, and higher studies. Screenshots of the created or updated profiles should be added in the repository as proof of completion.

Task 3 – Explore Coding and Collaboration Platforms

In this task, I worked with two categories of tools: a coding practice platform and Google Workspace collaboration tools. For coding practice, HackerRank is a suitable option because it offers beginner-friendly problems and helps students become familiar with logic-building and platform-based assessment. Completing even a basic challenge gives confidence and shows how online coding environments work. For collaboration, I designed a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. This form can be used to assess how well students understand topics such as digital safety, online professionalism, passwords, and responsible communication.

The linked Google Sheet response view is also useful because it turns the form into a simple academic data collection tool. These platforms are academically important because they train students in both technical practice and collaborative digital workflows. HackerRank supports problem-solving discipline, while Google Forms and Sheets support communication, surveying, teamwork, and data organisation. I found it

useful that this task felt practical and realistic rather than theoretical. It can directly help students in academic clubs, classroom surveys, coding preparation, and event organisation. Before final submission, screenshots of the coding challenge, Google Form, and response sheet should be added to the task folder and linked in the repository README.

Task 4 – Draft a Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

A common problem in digital communication occurs when students send casual or unclear emails to faculty members or professional contacts. For example, a student may write a message without a subject line, proper greeting, or full explanation, which can make the email look careless and reduce the chance of receiving a helpful response. In a professional setting, poor communication can create confusion, delay, or a negative impression. To avoid this, emails should include a clear subject line, a respectful greeting, a brief but complete body, and a proper sign-off with identity details.

Through this task, I learned that professional communication is not about writing long emails; it is about writing clear, respectful, and purposeful ones. The social media checklist in this task also reinforces the idea that responsible digital behaviour matters not only in formal emails but also on public platforms where a student's digital footprint can affect reputation and opportunities.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study and Prevention Guide

For this task, I selected phishing as the cybercrime topic because it is one of the most common and relevant online threats for students. While researching cybercrime, what surprised me the most was how simple tricks, like fake screenshots or urgent messages, can lead to serious financial loss. Many scams do not involve advanced hacking but instead rely on psychological manipulation, targeting trust and lack of awareness. I realized that even educated individuals, including college students, can fall victim to such scams if they are not cautious.

One personal habit I would change after researching this topic is that I will slow down before responding to any urgent-looking digital message, especially one related to payments, login alerts, or account verification. I will check the sender, verify the website

address, and never share OTPs or UPI PINs. This task made me understand that cyber safety begins with everyday habits. A student who knows how to identify fraud early can prevent financial loss, identity misuse, and long-term account compromise.

Conclusion

This project helped me see digital literacy as a complete life skill rather than a limited computer skill. It includes visual communication, professional identity, collaboration, email etiquette, and cyber safety. The project also showed that students can build useful digital habits early in college through simple tools such as GitHub, LinkedIn, Google Forms, and responsible communication practices. Overall, this portfolio reflects both awareness and practical action, which is the core purpose of digital literacy.

References

VIT Bhopal University, CSE0001 – Digital Literacy Project Assignment Brief.

GitHub – https://github.com/

LinkedIn – https://www.linkedin.com/

HackerRank – https://www.hackerrank.com/

Google Forms – https://forms.google.com/

National Cyber Crime Portal – https://cybercrime.gov.in/

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